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Democracy Dies in Darkness

TUESDAY, JUNE 17, 2025 • \$4

Trump leaves summit early

Departs G-7 to deal with Mideast, but declines to join statement on crisis

BY CAT ZAKRZEWSKI, AMANDA COLETTA AND CLEVE R. WOOTSON JR.

BANFF, ALBERTA — President Donald Trump planned to leave the Group of Seven summit a day early to attend to the conflict between Israel and Iran, the White House announced Monday, hours after he declined to join a statement at the meeting calling for de-escalation by both sides.

“I have to be back,” Trump told reporters Monday night while posing for photos. “You probably see what I see, and I have to be back as soon as I can.”

Trump posted a statement on his Truth Social platform declaring that “everyone should immediately evacuate Tehran!” — referring to Iran’s capital, which has a population of almost 10 million.

“AMERICA FIRST means many GREAT things, including the fact that, IRAN CAN NOT HAVE A NUCLEAR WEAPON. MAKE AMERICA GREAT AGAIN!!!” he wrote in a separate post.

Trump had been scheduled to meet Tuesday with Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky and Mexican President Claudia Sheinbaum.

“I wish I could stay for tomorrow, but they understand,” Trump

SEE G-7 ON A9

In Iran: Officials project strength as citizens fear for their safety. **A11**

Expanded presence: Pentagon deploys extra aircraft, ships. **A11**

Gasoline prices: U.S. drivers should expect an increase. **A13**

Arab gulf states work to mediate in Iran conflict

BY KAREEM FAHIM AND SUSANNAH GEORGE

Iranian officials have told mediators they are open to resuming nuclear talks with the United States, but they first want Israel to stop its attacks, two officials briefed on the matter said Monday, as fighting between the regional archrivals continued for a fourth day.

Tehran’s position, one official said, was that, “we never left the negotiating table, but no negotiations while we are under fire.” Oman and Qatar were leading efforts to begin ceasefire talks, the second official said — part of a frantic drive by Persian Gulf states to tamp down the intensifying conflict on their doorstep that began Friday, when Israel began striking Iran. Both officials spoke on the condition of anonymity because of the sensitive nature of the discussions.

The escalating conflict has fed a growing dread in the Persian Gulf, fueled by the region’s proximity to the conflict, memories of terrible wars past and confusion over how far Israel, Iran and the Trump

SEE CONFLICT ON A10



HEIDI LEVINE/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Damage from an Iranian strike can be seen in Bnei Brak, Israel, a predominantly ultra-Orthodox city near Tel Aviv, on Monday.



GETTY IMAGES

Smoke rises after Israel struck the headquarters of Iranian state television in Tehran, after issuing an evacuation warning for the area.

Police investigate disruptions at rallies



DYLAN MARTINEZ/REUTERS

A demonstrator is detained as protesters block U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement personnel from entering a building housing an immigration court in Chicago on Monday. Although the weekend’s “No Kings” protests were largely peaceful, police investigated several violent incidents, including one in Salt Lake City that left a bystander dead. **Story, A6**

Poorest households may feel more pain than gain from bill

BY THEODORIC MEYER AND JACOB BOGAGE

President Donald Trump and his Republican allies in Congress have pitched their sweeping tax-and-spending bill as a way to help the working-class voters who played a crucial role in electing Trump.

But funding cuts to Medicaid and other programs included in the legislation would hurt low-income households financially more than the tax cuts would

boost their finances, according to nonpartisan analyses of the bill. The biggest benefits would accrue to the highest-earning households, the analyses found.

The bill’s potential to hurt working-class Americans has complicated its path to passage in the Senate, where several Republicans have raised concerns about the effects of the Medicaid cuts, in

SEE TAXES ON A7

Making the case: Economist allies argue for benefits of budget bill. **A14**

Trump spurs effort to reward loyalty in federal workforce

BY MERYL KORNFIELD AND HANNAH NATANSON

President Donald Trump is accelerating efforts to transform the nonpartisan, merit-based federal workforce into one that demands and rewards loyalty to the president, according to civil servants, public service experts and employment attorneys.

The ongoing shift would ditch decades-old rules that were in-

tended to ensure that federal hiring, retention and promotion decisions are based largely on employees’ skills and experience, say the workers, experts and attorneys.

The House-passed budget proposal under consideration in the Senate would give new federal workers an ultimatum to accept “at-will” status — meaning they could be more easily fired — or

SEE HIRING ON A5

IN THE NEWS

Watchdog restrained Under Donald Trump, the Consumer Financial Protection Bureau has stopped pursuing a company accused of making predatory car loans. **A18**

Nurse shortage Locally and nationwide, schools are having trouble staffing health offices even as medical needs have risen. **B1**

THE NATION
A federal judge ordered hundreds of terminated NIH grants to be reinstated. **A2**
A virus expert quit the CDC after Robert F. Kennedy Jr.’s purge of vaccine advisers. **A6**

THE WORLD
Demonstrators marched in European cities to protest tourism saturation. **A8**
A familiar question has popped up in Brazil: Is Lula too old to run for president again? **A12**

THE ECONOMY
The Trump Organization is launching a mobile phone service that promises gold smartphones and a \$47-per-month price tag. **A13**
The president’s zeal for factory employment could pose a risk to growing segments of the economy. **A14**

THE REGION
With the primary more than a year away, five Democrats are already vying to succeed the Montgomery County executive. **B1**
The bald eagles at the National Arboretum — Mr. President and Lotus — did not produce any eaglets this spring. **B1**

STYLE
ACLU lawyer Chase Strangio is trying to help trans people, who have been targeted, exist in Trump’s America. **C1**
HEALTH & SCIENCE
Singing can promote brain health, soothe your mind and help you connect — even if you can’t carry a tune. **E1**

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The Washington Post
Year 148, No. 54250

